

Two People Running for Georgia Governor Hold a TV Debate

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This year, 36 states are choosing a **governor**. A **governor** is the leader of a state. In Georgia, the two main **candidates** met this week for their only **debate** on TV.

One candidate is Keisha Lance Bottoms, a Democrat who used to be the mayor of Atlanta. The other is Rick Jackson, a Republican businessman. Right now, Jackson is a little ahead in the **polls**.

Voters got to ask the **candidates** questions. They asked about the cost of living, cameras that read license plates, data centers, pay and a government health program called Medicaid.

Bottoms said Jackson has claimed he does not disagree with any of President Donald Trump's policies. Jackson did not say Trump's name. He compared himself to Georgia's current **governor**, Brian Kemp. Trump has **endorsed** Jackson.

Jackson's supporters said they like that he is a businessman and not a longtime **politician**. He is also spending lots of money on TV ads.

Today, the U.S. has 26 Republican **governors** and 24 Democratic **governors**.

Word Treasure

governor -- The leader of a U.S. state's government.

candidates -- People who are trying to win an election.

debate -- An event where people running for office answer questions and share their different ideas.

polls -- Surveys that ask people whom they plan to vote for.

endorsed -- Said in public that he supports someone.

politician -- A person whose job is working in government or running for office.

Background you need

A governor is the leader of a state, chosen by the people who vote there.

Before an election, candidates often hold debates so voters can hear their ideas and compare them.

Break it down

WHO: Democrat Keisha Lance Bottoms and Republican Rick Jackson

WHAT: Their only TV debate in the race for governor, where voters asked questions

WHERE: Georgia, one of 36 states choosing a governor this year

WHY: To help voters compare the candidates before they choose Georgia's next leader

Why it matters

The governor helps make decisions about things kids use every day, like schools and roads.

Test what you remember

1. How many states are choosing a governor this year?
 - (A) 50
 - (B) 10
 - (C) 36
 - (D) 24
2. Which job did Keisha Lance Bottoms have before?
 - (A) Mayor of Atlanta
 - (B) TV reporter
 - (C) Governor of Georgia
 - (D) Teacher
3. What is Rick Jackson's background?
 - (A) He is a doctor
 - (B) He is a mayor
 - (C) He is a Republican businessman
 - (D) He is a football coach
4. Who did Rick Jackson compare himself to?
 - (A) Brian Kemp, Georgia's current governor
 - (B) Abraham Lincoln
 - (C) Keisha Lance Bottoms
 - (D) Joe Biden
5. Who asked the candidates questions?
 - (A) Students
 - (B) Voters
 - (C) Movie stars
 - (D) Other governors
6. How many Republican governors does the U.S. have today?
 - (A) 50
 - (B) 24
 - (C) 36
 - (D) 26

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: A 3: C 4: A 5: B 6: D

Questions to think about

1. **Keisha Lance Bottoms: Says Jackson has claimed he does not disagree with any of President Trump's policies.**
2. **Rick Jackson's supporters: Like that he is a businessman and not a longtime politician.**

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):